

Account Lockout Policy & Unlock Procedures

This document outlines Blossom Banking's account lockout policy for online and mobile banking. Accounts are locked automatically to protect members from unauthorized access attempts. Both member self-service unlock options and staff-assisted procedures are covered.

1. Lockout Triggers

An online banking account is automatically locked after a defined number of consecutive failed login attempts within a rolling 30-minute window.

- 5 consecutive failed password attempts lock the account immediately.
- 3 consecutive failed MFA code entries lock the account after password success.
- Suspicious geographic login (new country or high-risk IP) may trigger a proactive lock.
- Admin-initiated lock applied during fraud investigation or member request.

2. Member Self-Service Unlock (Online)

Members can unlock their account without calling support using the self-service flow on the Blossom Banking login page.

Step-by-step:

- Navigate to blossombanking.com and click 'Unlock Account' below the login form.
- Enter your username and the email address on file.
- Blossom sends a 6-digit unlock code to your registered email and/or SMS.
- Enter the code within 10 minutes. The code expires after one use.
- Create a new password when prompted (the old password is invalidated on unlock).
- Log in with your new password and complete MFA verification.

Note: If your registered email is inaccessible, you must contact Member Support or visit a branch.

3. Lock Duration & Escalation

- Soft lock (failed attempts only): self-service unlock available immediately.
- Hard lock (fraud flag or admin action): requires staff verification before unlock.
- Accounts not unlocked within 90 days of a soft lock are escalated to hard lock.
- Three soft locks within 60 days trigger an automatic hard lock.

4. Staff-Assisted Unlock Procedure

Member Support agents and branch staff can unlock accounts using the back-office Administration Portal. The following verification steps are mandatory before any unlock.

Required verification:

- Full name and date of birth match records.
- Last four digits of the primary account number.
- Answer to one security question on file, or a one-time verification code sent to the member.
- For hard locks: supervisor approval required in addition to standard verification.

Back-office steps (staff only):

- Open Admin Portal > Member Management > Search by username or account number.
- Select the member record and navigate to 'Security Status'.
- Review the lock reason and audit trail.
- Click 'Unlock Account' and confirm your agent ID.
- Select whether to force a password reset on next login (required for fraud-flag locks).
- Document the unlock reason in the case notes field.

Important: Never unlock an account during an active fraud investigation without written authorization from the Fraud Prevention team. Doing so may compromise the investigation.

5. Member Communication

Blossom automatically sends a notification to the member's registered email and SMS whenever an account is locked or unlocked, including the timestamp and IP address of the triggering event. Members who did not initiate a lock should be advised to immediately change their password and review recent transactions.

6. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: My account is locked but I never entered the wrong password.

Accounts can be locked proactively if our fraud systems detect unusual activity, even without failed logins. Contact Member Support to investigate and unlock if warranted.

Q: The unlock code never arrived.

Check your spam folder first. Codes may take up to 5 minutes to arrive. If still missing, verify your registered email on file by calling Member Support. You can also request the code via SMS if a mobile number is registered.

Q: How long does it take for a staff-assisted unlock?

Typical processing time is under 5 minutes once identity is verified. Hard-lock unlocks requiring supervisor approval may take up to 30 minutes during peak hours.